Reading Comprehension — Lesson Handouts

Text reconstructed in source order, retaining headings, bullet points, line breaks and paragraph spacing where detected. OCR may contain recognition errors.

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Lesson 1.1: Your Reading Level

Reading better, not reading faster (put that stopwatch away)

Let’s be honest. RC has somehow become the only section where people think speed is intelligence. The faster

Page |1 YOU read, the smarter you must be. Fantastic logic. By that rule, the guy who skips the passage entirely and goes
‘straight to the questions should be a genius.
Everyone comes with the same plan:

e “I'll read faster.”

« “l'llincrease speed.”

© “I'll practise timing.”

Okay. Tell me one thing. After you finish reading the passage, do you know what it said, or are you just

emotionally confident that you read something? Because those two are very different experiences.
Let’s do basic maths. Even if you read at 100 words per minute — which is slow enough to annoy anyone —a

500-word passage takes five minutes. At normal speed, it’s three or four. That's it. That’s the reality. CAT is not
hiding the passage behind a countdown timer.
So if RC is killing you, speed is not the villain. Speed is just a distraction. This module is about reading better.

Not faster. Faster is for YouTube playback. Better is for comprehension.

How reading actually works (and how you wish it worked)

In your head, reading is one thing. One smooth activity. Words go in, meaning comes out. Beautiful. Reality is

uglier. Reading happens in levels:

1. Sentences
2. Paragraphs
3. Passage

And here’s the fun part: If you mess up at a lower level, everything above it collapses like cheap furniture. If

sentences don’t make sense, paragraphs don’t stand a chance. If paragraphs are shaky, the passage becomes
decorative. You're technically reading, but mentally you’re just scrolling.
Which is why we're not starting with passages. Or paragraphs. We're starting where most of you quietly lose the

plot — sentences.

“Sir, my vocabulary is weak” (the evergreen classic)

This sentence has survived generations. “Sir, my vocabulary is weak.” Relax. Vocabulary matters. Nobody is

saying vocabulary is useless. But vocabulary is not why most of you are bad at RC. If vocabulary were the issue,
CAT would be testing spelling bees.
The real moment of failure is much earlier. It’s when a sentence starts confidently, takes a left turn, adds two

side comments, throws in a clause from nowhere, and you mentally go, “Okay, something is happening... I’ll
just wait for the full stop.”
Once that happens, you're done. You can know every word in that sentence and still understand nothing. Your

eyes move. Your brain doesn’t. That’s why the first test | gave you had only sentences. No passage. No warm-up.
Just sentences looking at you like, “So?”

That test was not torture. It was exposure therapy.

Fifteen sentences. Each has between 35 and 87 words. That number wasn’t random. That’s the zone where

sentences stop behaving politely.

+ Some of you read them and thought, “What is this? Normal only.”
, © Some of you were okay till sentence five and then suddenly started reading the same line three times.
+ Some of you were lost before the sentence even reached the verb.

Excellent. That reaction tells me everything, This has nothing to do with intelligence. I've seen very smart
people get destroyed by long sentences and very average students handle them calmly. This is about one thing
only— can you hold a sentence together in your head without panicking?

The Picasso sentence (aka the confidence destroyer)

Picasso’s work, often taken—because of its fractured forms and radical visual departures—to represent a

decisive break from the artistic past, can more plausibly be understood, when placed against the inherited
concerns with representation, structure and experimentation that preoccupied earlier masters, as a continuation
of long-standing artistic traditions rather than the rupture itis frequently claimed to be.
‘Ah yes. Picasso. Everyone remembers this sentence, and not for good reasons. Now answer honestly. Which

word hurt you?
+ “Fractured”? You know that.

+ “Radical”? Please.

+ “Plausible”? Fancy, but manageable.

+ “Rupture”? Same family as fracture.

‘So vocabulary didn’t stab you in the back here. And yet most of you finished that sentence thinking, “Something

about Picasso... tradition... not sure.” That's when the problem becomes obvious. Knowing words didn’t help
you at all. Zero. Understanding words without understanding the sentence is Rotten logic. It feels productive,
but it goes nowhere.

What actually went wrong (and no, it wasn’t Picasso)

That sentence is not difficult. It’s irritating. At its heart, it’s saying something very boring: Picasso's work is not a

dramatic break from tradition; it continues older traditions. That's it. That’s the message.
‘So why did it feel like mental gymnastics? Because the sentence keeps interrupting itself. Extra information

Side explanations. Academic flexing. By the time it reaches the main point, you've forgotten how it started.
It you treat every part of the sentence as equally important, the main idea quietly dies somewhere after the

second comma. This is not a vocabulary problem. This is a structure problem. Vocabulary is just the excuse
you use so you don’t have to admit that.

Why this keeps happening to you (spoiler: it’s normal)

Most of you read in English, but think in your mother tongue. That's not a crime. Translating words is fine.

Translating sentence structure is where things fall apart. So you try to translate everything. Every word.
Every clause. Every pause. Your brain overloads. The sentence ends. You have words. No meaning.
Classic RC

experience.

Why this keeps happening to you (spoiler: it's normal)

experience.

Words scream. Structure whispers.

Words are loud. They're right there on the page. So when comprehension fails, you blame words. You decide to

improve your vocabulary. You download lists. You feel busy. After spending hours doing this, you realise: “That
didn't help!"
Reading more will naturally improve vocabulary, and that is the best way to improve vocabulary. By the time

1 you complete this course, you will have read so much to deal with any kind of ‘challenging vocabulary’.
But no amount of vocabulary will save you if sentence structure keeps slipping through your fingers. The reat
problem is quieter than that.

The only order that works (and yes, you'll resist it)

Here itis. Fightitif you want.

1. Structure first.
2. Logic next.

3, Words last.

That's the order. This is 100% the way. Ifthe structure is clear, one weird word won't stop you. If the structure is

a mess, knowing every word in the dictionary won't help. You'l still be guessing.

Why this lesson exists

'm not teaching tricks. 'm not giving hacks. 'm pointing out the real problem, so you stop fixing the wrong

thing. From here on, everything we do is about structure. Once that clicks, RC becomes manageable. Until
then, speed, vocabulary, and confidence are all just noise.

Lesson 1.2: The Essential Elements

Or: why sentences don’t exist to torture you (they just look like they do)

Last class ended with one instruction: Read for structure.

Page| Now, obviously, the next question is: structure of what? You can't read for structure ifyou don't know what the
hel the structure even is. So we're going back to basies. Proper basics. School-level basics. The stuff you think
you already know—which is exactly why you don’t
We're going to talk grammar. Relax. Nobody is testing correctness. Nobody is asking you to spot errors. I'm not
interested in whether a sentence is “right” or “wrong.” We're learning grammar for one reason only: as a map of
relationships. Who is connected to what, and how.
Because sentences don't exist to show off vocabulary They exist to do one job.

Why do sentences even exist inthe first place?

Asentence exists to convey one complete thought. That's it. Not two. Not half. One. If a sentence doesn't give
you a complete thought, it has failed at ite.
Sonnaturally, the next question is: what do you need to convey a complete thought? Answer: two things. Always.

1. Who or what are we talking about?
2. Whats being said about them?

That's it. That's the entire game. If either of these is missing, the sentence collapses.

Subject and Predicate (yes, those words again)

‘+ “Who or what we are talking about” is called the Subject.
‘+ “What we are saying about them” is called the Predicate.
I know, I know. You've heard these words before. Probably in school. Probably while half asleep. Doesn't matter
We're not using them like school did. We're using them like hunters.
Example 1:
“Doctors treat patients.”

* Whoare we talking about? Doctors. (Subject)
* What are we saying about them? They treat patients. (Predicate)

‘+ Complete thought. Sentence works.
Example 2:
“Policies affect everyday ite”
+ Whoare we talking about? Policies. (Subject)

* What are we saying about them? They affect everyday life. (Predicate)

‘Again, complete thought.

& Warning: The Subject is not always one word

This is where people start slipping. Look at this:
“Amonopoly over diagnosis and treatment disrupts essential care.”
Who are we talking about? No, not “monopoly.” Not “treatment” Not “diagnosis.” The entire chunk: A ‘monopoly over diagnosis and treatment.
That whole monster isthe Subject. And what are we saying about i? Thatit disrupts essential care.
Moral of the story: Stop hunting for one word. Sometimes the Subjects a full gang.

‘Some sentences don’t do actions. They just... exist.

“Immanuel Kant is a philosopher”
+ Who are we talking about? Immanuel Kant.
+ What are we saying? That he is a philosopher.
Notice something? Kant is not doing anything here, No action. No drama. He's just... bing,
Page|? Same thing here:
+ “Innovation becomes an instrument of social change.” (Innovation isn't punching anyone. I's becoming
something.)
+ “The policy appears a flawed solution.” (Translation: “The policy is flawed.")
These sentences aren't about action. They're about identity.

‘Wait—the Predicate has layers

Notice something? Kant is not doing anything here. No action. No drama. He's just... being.

Poee|2 Same thing here:

something.)

© “The policy appears a flawed solution.” (Translation: “The policy is flawed.")

1, The Verb: The action or the state of being. (The engine).

2. The Object: The person or thing that receives the action.
3. The Complement: A word or phrase that completes the meaning of the subject or object (usually by
describing it or renaming it).
Every Predicate you hunt will have a Verb, and it will usually have an Object, a Complement, or both. If you

‘Now pay attention. This is important. The Verb is the most powerful thing in a sentence. It decides everything

* Subject: Doctors

© Object: Patients

\& The Verb decides the structure.

© Who? The law. (Subject).

Pagel3 ~~ Whatis it doing? Makes. (Verb)

* Makes whom? Citizens. (Object)

“Excessive reliance on quantitative metrics makes human judgment secondary.”

They all look different. They sound different. But inside? Same structure. Every single time, your job is the

2. What are they doing/being?-

And then... the real problem begins

Lesson 1.3: The Interrupters

Or: the moment sentences stop behaving nicely

This is where the real game starts. Everything tll now was warm-up. Sentences were simple, cooperative,
‘almost polite. Then the interrupters walk in. And that's when most of you collapse.
Page| interrupters are the non-essentials. And before you get emotional, no, that does not mean they ere useless.
They give relevant information. Sometimes interesting information. Sometimes impressive information.
‘Sometimes information that makes the author feel very intelligent.
But they are not the essence of the sentence. The essence is still the same boring four things we did last class:
‘Subject, Verb, Object, Complement. That never changes. Ever.

Quick recap so nobody pretends to be confused

Essentials of a sentence:
© Subject: Who or what are we talking about?

+ Verb: What are they doing or being?
© Object: Who or what receives the action?
+ Complement: What completes the meaning?
Everything else? Decoration. Noise. Interruption.
Meet the clean sentence (before it gets ruined)

Take this sentence:
“Immanuel Kant found metaphysics problematic”

Boautiful. Simple. Clean.
+ Who? Immanuel Kant
+ What is he doing? Found.

+ Found what? Metaphysics
    * Found metaphysics what? Problematic.

Complete thought. Sentence is happy. Life is good. Now... let's destroy it.
Interrupters: same nonsense, many names

Grammatically, these things have fancy names. Adjectives. Adverbs. Clauses. Appositives. Prepositional phrases. Whatever. I don't care. You don't care. The Question Setter definitely doesn't care if you know the
names.
For us, they're all the same thing: interrupters. Their only job in life is to jump into the middle of a pertectiy
good sentence and distract you.

Where can interrupters attack from?

Anywhere. Literally anywhere. They can modify the subject, the verb, the object, or the complement. They can
come betore, after, in the middle, or in packs. No rules. Only chaos.

1. Attacking the subject

age 2 “Immanuel Kant found metaphysics problematic.”

Now someone asks: who is Kant? Where is he from?

+ “The German philosopher Immanuel Kant found metaphysics problematic.”
+ “The Enlightenment thinker Immanuel Kant found metaphysics problematic.”
+ “Immanuel Kant, one of the most influential thinkers, found metaphysics problematic.”

Is the bold part essential? No. Helpful? Maybe. But the sentence survives without it. Notice that last one: it tells
you more about what the author thinks of Kant than about Kant himselt. File that away.

RISE Rt a ee

© “The Enlightenment thinker Immanuel Kant found metaphysics problematic.”

* “Immanuel Kant deeply found metaphysics problematic.”

* “Immanuel Kant found metaphysics rooted in speculative reasoning problematic.”

* “Immanuel Kant found metaphysics inherently problematic for systematic philosophy.”

Kant found metaphysics problematic.

The Monster Sentence (118 words of pure intimidation)

problematic for systematic philosophy (as a disciplined, law-governed enterprise) after prolonged

independently of human cognition), Immanuel Kant, a philosopher whose systematic engagement with

rE ‘metaphysies) profoundly altered the trajectory of Enlightenment philosophy (by re-centring philosophy on the

problematic for systematic philosophy (as a disciplined, law-governed enterprise) after prolonged

deliberation shaped by his attempt to establish firm boundaries (conceptual rather than empirical) between

© Subject: Immanuel Kant.

© Object: Metaphysics.

Questions are built on the spine, not the decoration. Every past paper proves this. The Question Setter knows:

3. Let the object and complement fall into place.

Everything else? Background noise.

Lesson 1.4: Hierarchy of Ideas

When several ideas show up, which one gets VIP entry?

Let's be honest. Sooner or later you'll face passages where every sentence gives an idea, every paragraph gives

Page| three ideas, and the passage gives you a migraine. Your job isto do something that sounds simple butis the
whole exam: decide what to keep in your head and what to leave on the page.
That's the game. Not speed. Not vocabulary. Not "vibes
‘passage is basically a crowd. Sentence 1 is yelling. Sentence 2 is longer and yelling louder. Sentence 3 is trying to sound intelligent. And you have to decide: “Okay, boss, who is the main character here?” Because it
you carry every idea, you'll collapse by line 4 and start hallucinating options.
So remember this: ideas are not equal. There isa hierarchy. Some ideas are bosses. Some are interns. They
can all exist, but they don’t all deserve space in your head.
Don'toverthink it. The loudest partis not necessarily the central idea. The longest partis not necessarily the
central idea. People shout in real fe also, Doesn't mean they're important. Well do hierarchy inside a sentence first. Same logic later works for paragraphs and passages.
The six relationships that decide “who wins”

We'll use six usual frameworks. Not rocket science. Just patterns.

1. Framing
2. Addition
3. Cause and Effect
4. Contrast
5. Concession
6. Correction

Each one is basically a rule for deciding which idea you keep.

1. FRAMING

“Here’s the background. Now here’s the point.”
Framingis when one idea sets the context and the other idea actually matters.
+ Signal words for framing: in light of, given, during, atthe time when, from the perspective of, in the context of, historically.

* Example: “During the Enlightenment, Immanuel Kant developed a critical philosophy of knowledge.”

© The Logic: “During the Enlightenment” is background. Nice. Not the point. The point is: Kant. developed a critical philosophy of knowledge. If you ignore the framing, the sentence still survives.
‘That's how you know it's framing.

2. ADDITION

“Two ideas. Both important. Don't play favourites.”

[Addition is when the sentence gives you two ideas that stand independently, so you keep both.
+ Signal words: and, also, similary, likewise, as well as, not only...but also.
+ Note: while sometimes behaves like addition, because “while” is a criminal with multiple passports.
Page|2 Example: “Kant critiqued metaphysical speculation and developed a systematic account of knowledge.”
Two actions. Two ideas. Both survive. No“why", no “therefore”, no “but”, Just two items on the lst.
+ You keep both:

1. Kant critiqued metaphysical speculation.
2. Kant developed a systematic account of knowledge.

3. CAUSE AND EFFECT

‘Two actions. Two ideas. Both survive. No “why”, no “therefore”, no “but”. Just two items on the list.

© Signal words for effect-first: therefore, thus, hence, thereby, leading to, resulting in, consequently.

© The Logic: Cause (speculation lacked limits) » Effect (Kant developed account). Which do you keep?

* Example: “Immanuel Kant developed a systematic account of knowledge because metaphysical

“Two opposing ideas exist. Nobody is being chosen.”

Contrast is difference without struggle. Both ideas exist. You don't prioritise one. You just register the difference
Signal words: while (contrast), whereas, in contrast, by contrast, on the other hand.

Page |3 Example: “While Immanuel Kant emphasised the limits of human reason, earlier rationalist
© The Logic: Two opposing views. Both survive. Kant = limits. Earlier rationalists = expansive power. No

© Signal words: although, even though. (And yes, while sometimes acts as concession—| told you, it’s a

Example: “Although earlier rationalist philosophers stressed the expansive power of human reason,

* Concession: “Although | love my friends for the memories, | love my boyfriend for the future.” (Now.

the second idea is the focus. You know what's coming next: boyfriend talk.)

Quick summary (so your brain doesn’t melt)

scientific method, Aristotle engaged in a clear philosophical interrogation of the content of his theories of the

Page |4 This isn’t only for sentences. This is how you win paragraphs. You read a paragraph, you pick sentence ideas,

Applying this to paragraphs

 This isn’t only for sentences. This is how you win paragraphs. You read a paragraph, you pick sentence ideas,

Lesson 2.1: Sentence to Paragraph

Sentences are under control. Paragraphs are next.

Let's be clear about where we are. Day One was sentence control. Give me any sentence—20 words,60 words,

Page |1 118 words—I don't care. can pull out the essence. Subject. Verb. Object. Complement. | can spot interrupters.
I can handle multiple ideas inside one sentence and decide which idea survives.
That problem is solved. Now we move to the next problem: Paragraphs.
‘paragraph is not one idea. That’ the trap. Most people read a paragraph and think, “Okay, paragraph = one
idea." Wrong. A paragraph is multiple sentences, and each sentence gives you one idea. Sofa paragraph has
four sentences, you now have four ideas.
That's not comprehension yet. That's ust collection. And this is exactly why students get tired in RC. They keep
collecting ideas and never decide what to throw away.

How to read a paragraph (step by step, no nonsense)

This is the process. Burn it into your head:

1. You read sentence 1. You extract the idea of sentence 1. Not the whole sentence. 4to.8 words.
2. Youread sentence 2. Extract its idea. 4to 8 words.
3. Youread sentence 3. Extractits idea. 4to 8 words.

4, Youread sentence 4. Extract its idea. 4to 8 words.

Now stop reading. At this point, you are not “understanding the paragraph”. You are holding four ideas in your

hhead. That’ the real situation.

Now comes the only question that matters

You now ask one brutal question: Out of these four ideas... which one is the winner?
‘One idea will win, The other three will have jobs:

* background

+ explanation

© example

+ support

+ old view

+ setup for correction

But they don’t get to live in your head. You keep one idea. That idea is the main point ofthe paragraph. Thatiis
paragraph control.

Paragraphs behave exactly like sentences

This should feel familiar. A long sentence had:
+ multiple clauses
+ multiple interrupters
+ multiple ideas
Page |2 You used hierarchy of ideas to decice which idea survives. A paragraph is the same problem, just zoomed out.
Same logic. Bigger unit
+ Old view > corrected view > corrected view wins.
+ Claim > explanation > claim wins.

+ Context > point » point wins.

‘+ Problem > solution > solution wins.

‘Nothing new is happening. you can compress a sentence, you can compress a paragraph. A sentence with 80

words can be reduced to 4-8 words. A paragraph with 4 sentences can also be reduced to 4-8 words.
PRs RE ALESIS aN AS REE SRN SIE" SRI GIR ERIN
From paragraph to passage (same move again)

Why RC feels impossible without this.

By paragraph three, the brain is full. Then options look confusing. Then guessing starts. Controlled reading is

not speed reading. Controlled reading is selection.
© Whatis the sentence saying?

'» Whatis the paragraph saying?

knowledge of ultimate reality through pure reason.”

“.Jmmanuel Kant compellingly questioned the ambition...”

2. Identifying purpose at paragraph and passage level

Lesson 2.2: Paragraph Main Idea

(Or: why your brain keeps carrying useless ideas like emotional baggage

Let's get one thing straight before we begin. A paragraph is not one idea. Itit were, RC would be over in five

Page 1 Minutes and CAT would shut shop.
A paragraph is a collection of sentences, and each sentence gives you one idea. And your brain, bless its innocence, tries toremember all of them. That is @ 10096 false way to work.
So today we learn one thing and one thing only: Hew to read a paragraph and walk away with ONE idea.
+ Nottwo.
+ Nota“blena”

+ Nota polite summary.

+ One.

First: what “doodling” actually means (and why most people mess it up)

[paragraph may be 120 words, 150 words, or 220 words. Your job is to reduce that into four to eight words.
That four-to-eight-word thingis what | calla doodle.
‘Now listen carefully. Doodting is NOT:
+ summarising

+ integrating ideas
‘+ taking.a bit from sentence 1, sentence 2, sentence 3 and stitching something together
That's what students do when they panic and want to sound intelligent. Rotten.

Doodling is:

+ picking ONE idea
+ throwing away EVERY OTHER IDEA
‘+ writing only the idea that wins
it your doodle contains more than one idea, you have failed the task. Doodlingis elimination, not synthesis.

Dooling doesn’t take time. Indecision does.

Let's be honest. Every time | teach this, hear the same thing: “Gejo Sir, doodling takes alot of time.”

‘No. 100% false. And it's important to say this very clearly
\Writing 4-8 words does not take time. Nobody loses time writing six words. You can write it, you can not write it,
P98°|? vou can just keep it in your head—that part is completely immaterial.
What actually takes time is figuring out what the doodle should be. That process involves:

‘extracting one idea from each sentence

+ holding multiple sentence-ideas together
+ decidingwhich idea wins
+ and, most importantly, discarding the rest without panic
‘That decision-makingis where you hesitate. You start thinking like @ hoarder:

bc you can just keep it in your head—that part is completely immaterial.

The whole point is this: you need the doodle (in your head first!). Because without it, you will reread the

How to read a paragraph (the only way that works)

I don’t care how good your English is. This is mechanical. Do it every time. If a paragraph has four sentences:

2. Read Sentence 2 pull out its idea (4-8 words)

I dnt care ow good our Eglsh Tiss mechanical. Dot evr tine. paragraph has ou sentences:

1. Read Sentence 1 + pull out its idea (4-8 words)
3. Read Senance’~ pulloutsides 8 werd)

2, Read Sentence 2 > pull out its idea (4-8 words)
me 4. Read Sentence 4 — pull out its idea (4-8 words)

Now stop. You are not “understanding the paragraph” yet. You are holding four ideas. Now ask the only question

thatmaters Out ofthese leas which one Survives?
That survivor is the main point of the paragraph. Everything else stays in the text like background actors.

Why some sentences never win

Every sentence in a paragraph has a job.
+ Point -the reason he prasaph exits
Common obs

* background Contest-stge sting

{Explanation "what exact do you mean?”
{Evidence Reason why shoud bleve you
© Qualifier -“not always / not fully”
{Counterpoint Correction “people soyX, but otualy
Only one sentenced gets tbe the Pint. Evryon oles suppot stat.

Worked Paragraph 1: Metaphysics, Science, Plato (4 sentences)

The Paragraph:

In the past, philosophical metaphysics and the natural sciences circled one another like partners in an elaborate dance,
cach leaning upon the other and at times pushing or pulling its partner along as they both attempted to step lively to

the rhythm of reality. Since Pythagoras, who is traditionally recognised as the first to coin the word philosophy, the
page a tatural and mathematical sciences were posited asthe proper guide and escort of this complicated dance. Plato's
3°4 enjoinder that those who sought to study the true form of being in his Academy must first familiarise themselves with
‘mathematics and thei practical application in the natural sciences. Supposedly, the inseription above the entrance to
his Academy read: “Let no one enter who is ignorant of the study of geometry.”

Sentence-ideas:

‘+ St: Metaphysics and science interacted historically > Background

‘#82: Natural and mathematical sciences guided philosophy > POINT

‘+ $3: Plato required maths before philosophy ~ Evidence

‘+ $4: Geometry prerequisite for philosophical study -> Evidence

Doodle (winner): Natural and mathematical sciences guided philosophy.

Purpose: neutral, explanatory.

Worked Paragraph 2: Health, Caregiving, Productivity (5 sentences)

The Paragraph:
Health problems, such as chronic conditions, ean greatly affect patients’ ability to take on and maintain work at their
full capacity. The work productivity of family caregivers may also be negatively influenced because of their
caregiving responsibilities. The impact of health or caregiving responsibilities on work can be assessed by measuring
‘one’s work productivity loss, which commonly includes the main components, absenteeism and presentecism.
"Absenteeism is one of the components and refers to absent work time while one is employed because of health
problems for patients or caregiving responsibilities. Productivity loss may also happen while at work, which is defined
as presenteeism.

Sentence-ideas:

+ S1:Health problems reduce work capacity > Background

+ $2: Caregiving duties reduce productivity > Background

‘+ $3:Impact measured via absenteeism and presenteeism -> POINT

+ Sé: Absenteeism means missing work -> Explanation

‘+ $5: Productivity loss at work means presenteeism -> Explanation

Doodle: Work productivity impact measured using absenteeism and presenteeism.

Purpose: informational.

Worked Paragraph 3: Colonialism (7 sentences)

The Paragraph:
‘There is no essential colonialism. The meanings and interpretations of colonialism are contingent on different eras,
different places, and diferent territorial relationships. These have been shaped by particular contexts of politics,
economics, culture, and geography. There is, however, general agreement that our contemporary world geography is a

5. -< result of European (and American) colonial practices that have occurred over the past five centuries. In effect, these

‘economics, culture, and geography. There is, however, general agreement that our contemporary world geography is a

page| ssl of European (and American colonial practice that have occurred over the pas five centres. In eet, these
"8° Sowers constructed the current political world. Modern state boundaries are largely a reflection of colonial histories
and rivalries. It is instructive,' therefore, to consider how colonies were established, administered, and maintained.

» $4:° Modern geography shaped by colonial practices > Pivot

* $5: Colonial powers constructed political world > POINT

* $7: Study colonial administration > Implication:

Worked Paragraph 4: Utilitarianism (8 sentences)

insisting that we should examine these values one at a time and ask why they matter. When people lic, their lies are

often discovered and those betrayed feel hurt and angry; when people break promises, they irritate neighbours and

be honest, dependable, respectful, and loving to our children, Utilitarianism explains why those qualities are good.

Worked Paragraph 5: Al Images and Regulation (5 sentences)

‘The eruption of Al-generated bikini images of women and children on X should be treated as a decisive test of the

online safety laws bend before corporate power. The government is right to condemn the monetisation of image-

Pade |6 apps, yet hesitation or delay would only embolden platforms that profit from pushing boundaries first and answering

for the damage later. With other countries already restricting access to such tools and the threat of deepfake
pomography set to intensify, the UK cannot afford half-measures. If democratic control over tech is to mean anything,

Final rule (write this on your soul)

Lesson 2.3: Paragraph Structure

Writers aren't random. Your reading shouldn't be either.

Inthe previous lesson, we learnt how to find the main point of a paragraph. That main points your doodle —

Page| fOur to eight words, one idea. Everything else is discarded

Now we go one level deeper. It’s not enough to find the point. You also need to understand how the paragraph is

built around that point, Paragraphs are not random collections of sentences. They follow structures. And once

you see the structure, RC stops feeling like reading and starts feeling like decoding.

Sentence roles

Every sentence in a paragraph belongs to one of these groups:

1. Point

© What the author wants to say

© The reason the paragraph exists

2. Background / Counterpoint

© Context

© Oldview

© Stage-setting

3. Support

© Explanation

© Reason

© Evidence

© Example

The common paragraph structures:

Most paragraphs you'll see fall into one of these:

+ Point > Support

© Support -> Point (rare)

+ Point > Support-> Point (restatement)

© Background / Counterpoint -> Point -> Support

+ Point + Qualifier > Support

‘Same ingredients. Different order.

‘Structure 1: Point-> Support

Paragraph:

Romantic ethics locates moral authority in individual fecling and moral intuition rather than in universal

‘moral rules. Romantic thinkers distrusted universal moral systems because such systems were formulated ta level of
abstraction that detached ethics from lived human experience. They argued that rules derived independently of
age concrete life inevitably flatten morally relevant differences between situations, Jean-Jacques Rousseau, for example,
rejected mora reasoning based on calculation or convention and treated natural sentiment as a more original souree of
‘moral judgement.

What's happening:

+ Sentence 1 = Point
+ Sentences 2-4 = Support

Doodle: Romantic ethics bases morality on individual feeling and intuition
page 2 CONTI life inevitably flatten morally relevant differences between situations. Jean-Jacques Rousseau, for example,

inevitably flatten morally relevant differences between situations. Jean-Jacques Rousseau, for example, rejected moral

* Sentence 4 = Point (signalled by “therefore”)

‘Structure 3: Point -> Support -> Point (restatement)

Romantic ethics challenges the authority of universal moral rules. Romantic thinkers distrusted ethical systems

* Middle sentences = Support

Moral philosophy in the eighteenth and early nineteenth centuries was marked by sustained attempts to systematise

rather than in universal moral rules. Romantic thinkers argued that rule-based systems operate at a level of

Doodle: Romantic ethics departs from universal-rule morality

——EEEEEooooo———————————————— st

Romantic ethics departs from this view by locating moral authority in individual feeling and moral intuition

a more original source of moral judgement than rational calculation.

What's happening:

* Sentence 1 = Qualifier

Lesson 2.4: Knowing the Purpose

(Or: Why “What is being said” is not enough
Till now, we have done a lot of work on control. We started with sentences, separated essential from non-
Page| 1 essential, and understood the hierarchy of ideas. Then we moved to paragraphs and learned how to doodle.
‘Soa very obvious question comes up: “Gejo Sir, if | can get the main idea of each paragraph, why should | care
‘about purpose?”
Because this is where inference lives.

WHAT vs WHY

When you identify a main idea, you are asking: What exists in the paragraph?
Purpose answers a very diferent question: Why did the author decide to write this at all?

‘Main idea is content.
‘Purpose is intent.
And intent tells you where the passage is going.

Why Purpose Matters While Reading

Imagine reading only the frst paragraph of a passage. Ifyou already know what kind of author this is, what role
they are playing, and what they are trying to do, you automatically start anticipating what will follow.
That is real reading. I's tke real ie: If your boss says, “We need to talk” your frst concern is not what, it is why.

‘Are you getting fired or are you getting a promotion? The "What" is the same, but the "Why" changes your entire
heart rate.

Question Types That Depend on Purpose

Purpose directly powers:

+ Tone
+ Author agreement / disagreement
+ Strengthen / Weaken
+ Assumption
+ Inference
+ Function of paragraph

‘Also, we will be able to eliminate options based on a mismatch in tone. fan option does not align with the

author's purpose, it dies. Even iit sounds intelligent.

Three Things You Must Keep Separate

WHATis boing said || The core contentidoodt.

Tones the atitude.

Purpose is revealed through that attitude.

‘Same Event. Different Author Roles.

age 2 WHY sitbeingsaid |] The undertyingintent.

online satirical persona “Empress Kuzcooo” — a parody character of an elderly villager whose tightly wor hijab

sketch, which recited verses from the Shahnameh with irreverent commentary, drew condemnation online and from.

Passage (Analysis)

‘online satirical persona “Empress Kuzcooo” — a parody character of an elderly villager whose tightly wor hijab

‘Tone: Neutral, Explanatory

Passage (Analysis)

merely from humour, but from the perceived transgression of a protected cultural domain where certain texts and

conditions such reinterpretation is deemed acceptable.

This is evaluation without judgement.

waeeeaa

to produce a supervised thesis under institutional oversight turns incarceration into indoctrination, It sends a warning

© “chilling”

Purpose: To Justify / Defend

historical memory and national continuity in the face of repeated political and social upheaval. When such texts are

individual expression. While such limits may appear severe to outsiders, they are often defended internally as

* “civic responsibility”

Purpose is revealed by how something is written, not by what it talks about.

Why We Now Move to Passage Control

Purpose tells you why it exists.

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